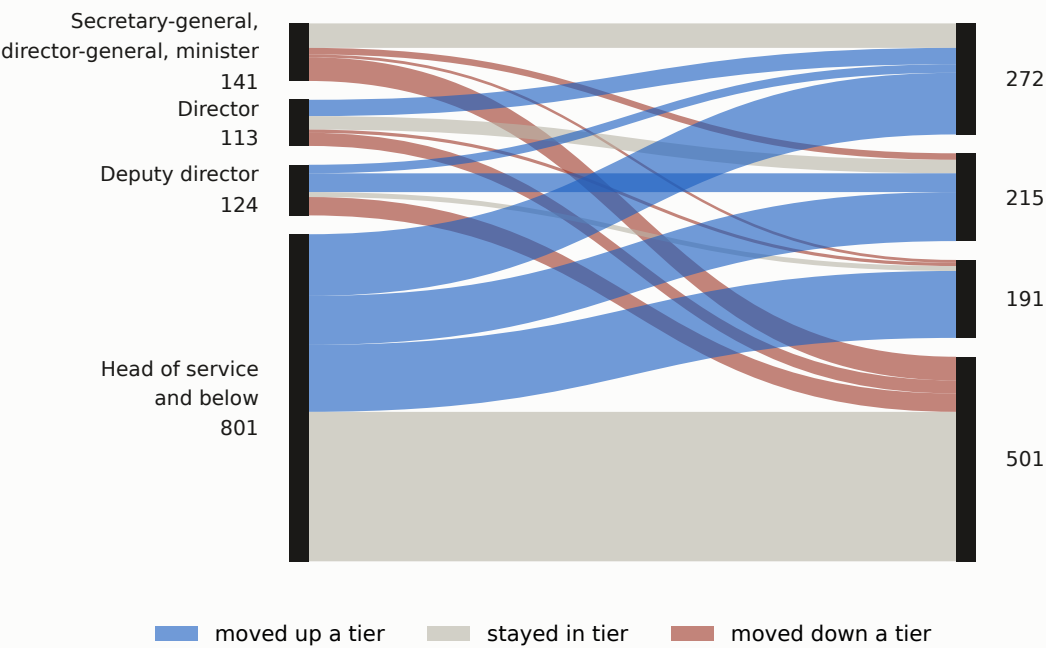


1987: where the officeholders went ▪ Ben Ali displaces Bourguiba

Of the 9,792 people holding an office on 7 Nov 1987, the 1,179 who took a further post within three years (12%), by the rank they held and the rank they moved to. Of the 141 standing at secretary-general or above, 58 (41%) next appear at head of service or below, against 45% for the same cohort in ordinary times: a difference of -3 points. The remaining 8,613 of the cohort have no further post in the record, which the gazette's patchy treatment of departures makes unreadable as removal from the state.



Source: Journal Officiel de la République Tunisienne, 1957–2026 (6,378 French issues, jort.tn). Author's extraction. Rank is the ordinal scale in the codebook; a person holding several posts is placed at the highest, before and after alike. Ministers and governors are folded into the senior tier, supplying only 38, 11 and 4 movers across the three ruptures. Ribbon width is people, and the columns are scaled to the same total, so tier heights on the two sides are comparable. These diagrams are descriptive and carry no counterfactual: a tier that looks busy may simply be a busy tier. Whether a rupture demoted more than its era ordinarily did is the question the demotion figure answers, against placebo cohorts. That figure also counts any fall in rank, where these count only falls that cross a tier boundary - 946 against 537 in 2021 - so its percentages are the larger of the two and the two are not in conflict. The three diagrams resemble one another because most of what they show is the standing mobility of the bureaucracy rather than the rupture: across the whole matrix the ruptures differ from each other by 5.6 to 6.5 points on average, and each from its own ordinary times by 3.1 to 7.0.